



Figure 1: Local host

configured on the system. To check whether it is already installed, just try typing 'localhost' on your browser. If you see something like what's shown in Figure 1, then you are ready with the local host.

Now we can start with setting up the Owncloud developer environment.

Make a directory called *Owncloud* in a location where you have write permission, type the given code in your terminal, and execute it:

```
sudo mkdir /var/www/owncloud
```

```
sudo chown YOURUSERNAME:YOURGROUP /var/www/owncloud
```



Note: You should replace **YOURUSERNAME:YOURGROUP** with your own username and groupname.

```
chmod a+rw /var/www/owncloud
```

Now you should have a ready-to-develop set-up in your localhost. You can check it on <http://localhost/owncloud/core/>. You will see something like what is shown in Figure 2.

Once you are ready with your set-up, you can clone the core. All source code is available on Github. So we can simply clone it from Github, for which you just follow the commands given below.

First, enter the *Owncloud* directory, which you have already created. For that, type the following command:

```
cd /var/www/owncloud
```

Now we have to clone into this directory from Git. To clone the core, type the following:

```
git clone https://github.com/owncloud/core.git
```

If you are planning to contribute or are interested in



Figure 2: Owncloud on localhost

working with Owncloud applications, then you can simply clone that also from Git. For that, type the following:

```
git clone https://github.com/owncloud/apps.git
```

You can now change your directory to core, and then type the following on your terminal to set up your developer environment:

```
cd core/
git submodule init
git submodule update
mkdir data
sudo chown -R www-data:www-data config/
sudo chown -R www-data:www-data data/
sudo chown -R www-data:www-data apps/
```

Once you are done with these steps, you will be able to access your Owncloud with its original credentials. You can store your files, etc, in the same setup.

Contributing to Owncloud

As I mentioned earlier, Owncloud started out in 2010. It's still under development and the community supports new contributors as well as beginners with essential requirements.

You can find Owncloud issues on Github. For beginners, I recommend that you start with minor jobs. Owncloud has been listed among GSoC (Google Summer of Code) participating organisations, and also on OPW (the FOSS Outreach Program for Women). The IRC channels of Owncloud are very active and are really helpful.

If you are interested in cloud computing or private clouds, I suggest you start contributing to Owncloud and feel the beauty of cloud computing. **END** 

By: Anjana S

The author is an open source enthusiast. She can be reached at anjanasasindran123@gmail.com.